

CRIME INVESTIGATION - VICTIM AND INCIDENT REPORT

Case Reference: HBL-2026-KD-0074

Prepared by: Inspector Vinayak Patil, Vidyanagar Police Station, Hubballi

Date: Incident: 17 August 2026 | Report: 22 August 2026

1. Victim Information

Victim: Girish Kulkarni, age 52, owner of Kulkarni Agencies, a wholesale agricultural commodity trading business in Hubballi. Married to Rohini Kulkarni with two adult children. Known to handle large cash transactions and to lend money informally.

2. Incident Summary

On the evening of 17 August 2026 at about 8:10 PM, Girish Kulkarni was abducted from the parking area of his warehouse by four men in a grey Tempo Traveller. A ransom call was made to his wife at 9:30 PM demanding Rs. 1.5 crore. After negotiations, Rs. 40 lakh was paid on 19 August at a roadside drop near Dharwad. The victim was rescued by police from a farmhouse near Kalghatgi on 21 August with minor injuries.

3. Circumstances

The warehouse's parking camera had been switched off about an hour before the abduction, and the guard on duty was away from his post. The abductors knew the victim's schedule and that he would be carrying cash that evening after collecting payments.

4. Known Conflicts

The victim recently dismissed his accountant, Sanjay Patil, for embezzling about Rs. 9 lakh. He owed a private financier, Prakash Jadhav, Rs. 25 lakh. A younger brother Amit Kulkarni was in a dispute over the family property. A business rival Mohan Desai had threatened to ruin him after losing a contract.